Our Vision

The Ghana We Are Working Toward

Our vision is to transform the educational landscape in Ghana by creating a thriving community where every student, regardless of their background, has the opportunity to reach their full potential. We aspire to be a beacon of educational excellence and a catalyst for positive societal change, nurturing future leaders who are equipped to address global challenges and contribute meaningfully to their communities.

This vision is not an abstraction. It is a picture of a specific Ghana, one we believe is within reach in our lifetime, and one that Somboh Educational Foundation (SEF Ghana) exists to help build.

A Ghana Where Talent, Not Circumstance, Decides

We imagine a Ghana where a gifted student in a rural district has the same chance at a world-class education as a student in the heart of Accra. Where a girl who loves physics is encouraged to pursue engineering. Where a family's income determines nothing about how far a child's mind can travel.

Today, that Ghana does not yet exist. The country has made bold progress in opening secondary education, but the path beyond it remains steep. Of roughly 446,000 students who completed WASSCE in 2021, only about 36% went on to tertiary education the following year, with financing cited as a major barrier for needy students. Ghana has set itself a goal of reaching a 40% gross tertiary enrollment rate by 2030. We want to help the nation not only meet that goal but surpass it, and we want to make sure the students who rise are chosen by their potential, not their postcode.

What Transformation Looks Like

When we speak of transforming the educational landscape, we mean change that families, teachers, and communities can see and feel:

- **From classroom to campus:** every high-achieving student in Ghana knows that full scholarships to leading universities at home and abroad exist, understands how to pursue them, and has someone to guide them through the process.
- **Information as a right, not a privilege:** knowledge about admissions, testing, essays, and financial aid moves freely across the country, rather than circulating only among families who already have connections.
- **Teachers and counsellors empowered:** school staff across Ghana are equipped with the tools and training to identify talent early and support students toward their goals.
- **A culture of ambition:** students grow up believing that the world's best institutions are open to them, because they see peers from their own schools and towns walking through those doors.

A Thriving Community

We believe no student succeeds alone. Our vision is of a community that surrounds every young person with support: mentors who have walked the path before them, alumni who reach back to pull others forward, parents who understand the process, and partners at home and abroad who invest in Ghana's young people.

As our scholars graduate and build their careers, they become the foundation of this community. They return as mentors, advisers, donors, and role models. Over time, we see SEF growing from an organization into a movement: a living network of Ghanaians across continents, bound by a shared commitment to opening doors for the next generation.

A Beacon of Educational Excellence

We aspire to set the standard for what college preparation and scholarship support can look like in West Africa. That means programs that are rigorous, personal, and grounded in evidence. It means measuring our success by real outcomes: students admitted, scholarships secured, degrees completed, and lives changed.

We want universities around the world to recognize an SEF scholar as a student who has been thoughtfully prepared and who will thrive on their campus. We want families in Ghana to recognize SEF as a name they can trust. And we want other organizations to look to our work as a model worth sharing and multiplying.

A Catalyst for Positive Societal Change

Education is the most powerful lever we know for changing a nation's trajectory. Every student who gains access to a world-class education carries the potential to change not only their own life, but the lives of their family and community.

We envision SEF scholars becoming the engineers who build Ghana's infrastructure, the physicians and public health leaders who strengthen its health systems, the entrepreneurs who create jobs, the scientists who solve problems unique to our region, the policymakers who govern with vision, and the educators and artists who shape how future generations think and dream. Each of them will multiply the impact of the opportunity they received.

Leaders Equipped for Global Challenges

The challenges of the coming decades, from climate change and public health to technology, economic opportunity, and governance, will not respect borders. Africa will be at the center of the world's future, and Africa's young people will be essential to solving its greatest problems.

We want to nurture leaders who are globally educated yet deeply rooted, who can move confidently between Accra and Boston, Kumasi and London, and who bring the best of the world home with them. Our scholars will be defined not only by their academic achievement but by their integrity,

empathy, resilience, and sense of responsibility to others.

Contributing Meaningfully to Their Communities

Above all, we envision a generation that measures success by what it gives back. We hope to see SEF scholars founding schools, funding scholarships, mentoring young people, and leading initiatives that improve life in the communities that raised them. In their success, we will see the true fulfilment of our vision.

Our Commitment

> *We dream of a Ghana where brilliance is never wasted.*

Every program we design, every student we mentor, and every partnership we build moves us one step closer to that future. The road is long, but the destination is clear: a Ghana where every student, regardless of background, has the chance to reach their full potential, and where those students rise to lead their communities, their country, and the world.

Data sources: Africa Education Watch via Modern Ghana (WASSCE-to-tertiary transition and 2030 tertiary enrollment target).